

S05-02 - Short Rest Before the Storm

Player read-aloud

For a little while, the Old Sable gives you room to breathe.

Scene summary

The party takes a short rest while the Custodian prepares the ritual.

Visible choices

- Tend wounds
- Clear stress
- Repair armor
- Prepare together

Player questions

- During the short rest, who helps someone else without making a big deal of it?
- What do you prepare that is not a weapon?
- What fear do you admit before the ritual starts?

GM notes

- Ask each player how they prepare. Give them ownership of the battlefield.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.

Checks and rolls

- Any fitting trait Prepare, comfort, ward, scout, or confess. Easy Grant a small situational edge. 10 Cleanly resolve: Prepare, comfort, ward, scout, or confess. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Short Rest Before the Storm. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Custodian composure She can be steadied. She has been doing this alone too long.

Kindness changes how she enters the ritual.

Loot

- One named preparation boon
- One final question answered

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Five pressure: The party takes a short rest while the Custodian prepares the ritual.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s05-02-use-the-short-rest-with-intention S05-02 Use the short rest with intention Use the short rest with intention Presence Finesse Knowledge Presence Finesse, Knowledge 10 Presence tends emotions; Finesse repairs gear; Knowledge prepares the field. The rest becomes bookkeeping instead of care before danger. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the...
- Gm Fear Spends: Tick the Ritual Countdown the wrong direction or expose the Custodian. Trigger Market Correction, Pass-Through, Memory Delve, or Group Attack when fiction supports it.
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Short Rest Before the Storm asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Finesse, Knowledge, Presence. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural

weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress.
Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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